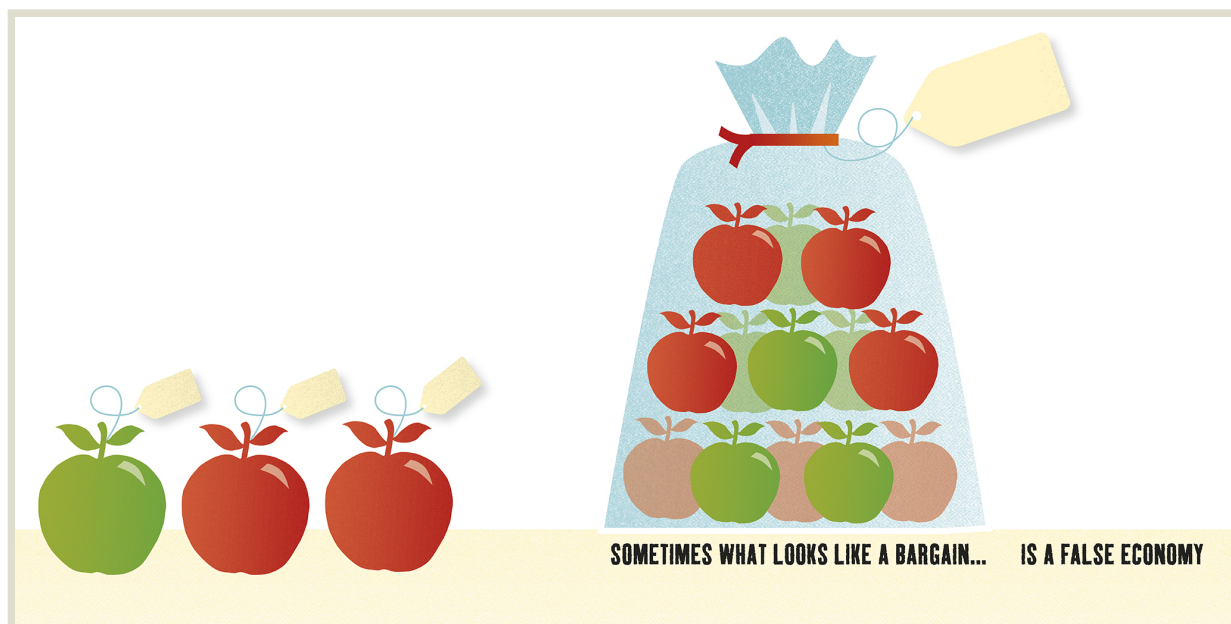


rather than a packaged prepared meal or takeout. Having a car is also more convenient than using public transportation, but can be more expensive to run, and the latest smartphone may look cool, but is it much more useful than the one you already have?



#### **Bagging a bargain**

Buying a big bag of apples, rather than getting them one by one, might save you money, but only if you eat them all before they go bad.

### **Small changes, big savings**

But you don't have to make changes to your lifestyle to save money. In your regular grocery shopping, it pays to plan ahead and buy the cheaper economy sizes of some products, rather than simply buying things as and when you need them, and it's worth looking for special offers. It's also important to think about how much you really need, and whether you'll be able to use everything before its best-before date. Throwing away unused food is money down the drain, and a surprisingly large proportion of many people's expenditure. Beware, too, of being tempted by a bargain. If something seems too good to be true, it often turns out to be a false economy. Especially when buying things like clothes, furniture, or electrical goods, it's often wise to spend a bit more to get something that will last longer. Take the time to shop